

Robustness Check Results

How Local Regime Type Shapes Political Expression: Self-Censorship in Argentina's Subnational Units

Outcome	Alternative specification	Controls	SDI estimate	Std. error	p-value	N	Summary of result
Conversational self-censorship (DV1)	Single-level logistic regression without province-level random effects	Full controls	0.277	0.111	0.012*	624	Higher SDI remains associated with a greater likelihood of talking about politics.
Survey-based self-censorship (DV2)	Binary indicator of any sensitive-item nonresponse across domains	Baseline	-0.200	0.072	0.006**	1,003	Higher SDI is associated with a lower likelihood of any sensitive-item nonresponse.
Survey-based self-censorship (DV2)	Binary indicator of any sensitive-item nonresponse across domains	Full controls	-0.156	0.102	0.127	626	After controls, the association attenuates and is not statistically significant.

Notes

SDI = Subnational Democracy Index; higher values indicate greater provincial democratic quality. DV1 removes the province-level random intercept from the main specification. DV2 collapses nonresponse across sensitive political domains into a binary indicator of any NA/DK response. The DV2 alternative models produced zero or approximately zero province-level random-intercept variance. * $p < 0.05$; ** $p < 0.01$.

Source: Appendix F.3, Robustness Checks.